# Claim Matrix

Claim Type × Evidence Grade

| LANE ↓ | EG-0<br>Account only | EG-1<br>Documented basis | EG-2<br>Independent check | EG-3<br>Adversarial check |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **LANE A**<br>Observation<br>“I saw it happen.” | An observation is reported. Its accuracy has not yet been checked; the account remains a starting point.<br>**OPEN** | The observation has a record that can be inspected. Independent confirmation is still missing.<br>**PROVISIONAL** | A separate observation or independent method supports the reported event. Check that it covers the same claim.<br>**SUPPORTED*** | The observation survives independently assessed attempts to disprove it. The challenges and their results can be inspected.<br>**STRONG SUPPORT*** |
| **LANE B**<br>Inference<br>“It stands to reason…” | A conclusion is offered, but its supporting evidence or reasoning has not yet been shown.<br>**OPEN** | The premises and reasoning are available for inspection. The conclusion still awaits an independent check.<br>**PROVISIONAL** | An independent check supports the inference. Identify which premises, reasoning, or conclusion were actually checked.<br>**SUPPORTED*** | The inference survives independently assessed tests of rival explanations and critical assumptions. The challenges and results can be inspected.<br>**STRONG SUPPORT*** |
| **LANE C**<br>Scenario<br>“Imagine if…” | An imagined possibility opens a question. It is not evidence that the imagined event happened.<br>**EXPLORATORY** | The scenario has stated assumptions or a model. Its usefulness depends on those assumptions.<br>**EXPLORATORY** | Independent checks support aspects of the model. The imagined event itself remains hypothetical.<br>**CHECKED MODEL** | The model survives deliberate challenges. This strengthens the exploration, not a claim that the imagined event occurred.<br>**TESTED MODEL** |

Blue: open · Amber: provisional or model only · Green: supported* · Grey: exploration

*The green cells describe claims supported by their checks. A check must support the stated claim before a green label applies.

A and B identify different kinds of claim, not higher and lower truth. Explanation: page 2.

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# Reference notes

Lane definitions · evidence grades · cell labels · companion instrument

### Y axis - Lane: claim type

Lane A - Observation. What someone reports seeing, reading, or measuring. It identifies the kind of claim, not whether perception, memory, or reporting was accurate.

Lane B - Inference. A conclusion drawn from evidence or premises. Make the reasoning inspectable. Inference is not inherently weaker than observation; equal checking can give either strong support.

Lane C - Scenario. An imagined possibility, model, or counterfactual. It generates questions. Checking a model does not establish that an imagined event happened.

Split a statement containing both observation and inference where the difference matters. Preserve the original words and identify any narrower claim separately.

### Companion instrument - the Witness Matrix

The Claim Matrix examines the claim and its checks. The Witness Matrix examines the source's credibility and expressed confidence. The questions differ, but their answers can interact.

Ask what support remains without this source's contribution. Independent support can reduce dependence on the source; new source information can require a fresh claim assessment.

### X axis - Evidence grade

EG-0 - Account only. The report or conclusion is available, but its accuracy or basis has not been checked. Testimony still supplies information; record reasons for giving it weight.

EG-1 - Documented basis. A record, or the premises and reasoning, can be inspected. Documentation alone is not independent confirmation.

EG-2 - Independent check. A separate observation, method, or analysis checks a relevant part of the claim. State which part it checks.

EG-3 - Adversarial check. Deliberate attempts to disprove the claim, test rival explanations, or challenge critical assumptions receive independent assessment.

These are checking positions, not mandatory historical steps. A previously unrecorded account can later receive independent corroboration.

### Independence and action

Copies of one originating account are not independent witnesses. Separate interviews alone do not establish independence. An independent analysis of shared data can check a method without independently establishing the data's origin.

Keep a decision to act separate. Stakes, reversibility, and the cost of waiting matter; a precaution can precede corroboration.

### Reading the cell labels

Open: an account or conclusion awaits checking. Provisional: a documented basis is available, but independent checking is still outstanding. Supported: an independent check supports the claim. Strong support: it also survives independently assessed challenge.

The green cells describe claims that survive the relevant checks. A check is not a success merely because it took place. If the claim fails a check, explain what failed; do not award the green label.

Use all relevant checks. Losing one reason for belief may leave a question open without settling it. A camera record is useful only to the extent that its timing, coverage, and resolution address the event being claimed.

### Lane C

An exploration may be useful without being evidence that its imagined event occurred. Check its factual assumptions and predictions as separate Lane A or B claims.

A shared vocabulary for assessment. Record the reason for placement; the sheet does not replace that reason.

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